Lens Brainstorm

Participatory activities for purposeful, transparent, and people-centric dataset documentation

Lens Brainstorm

Prerequisite checklist

BEFORE YOU BEGIN

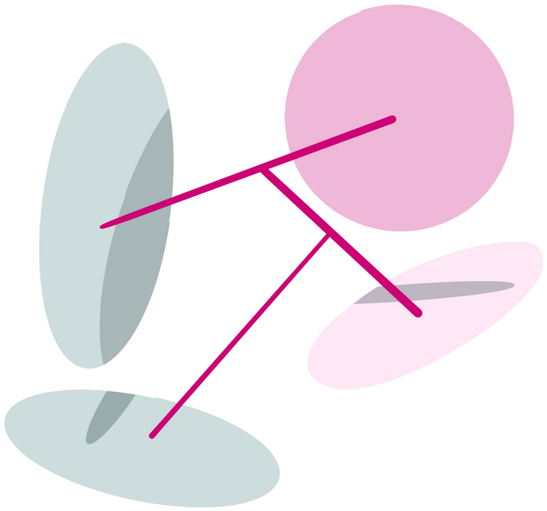
–

→ Read through OFTEn Framework

→ Read through Agent Information Journeys

→ Decide on your agents using Priority Matrix and/or Align on Agents

→ Update results from aforementioned in the Activity Tracker for future reference



Activity — Lens Brainstorm

Lens - Origins

As a: <perspective>

I want to know

_____

_____

ORIGINS: A short, succinct statement that conveys a single idea about the early stages of a dataset's lifecycle when decisions to create a dataset are made.

Lens - Factuals

As a: <perspective>

I want to know

_____

_____

FACTUALS: A short, succinct statement that conveys a single idea about the process of collecting, labeling, rating examples, and corresponding outputs.

Lens - Transformations

As a: <perspective>

I want to know

_____

_____

TRANSFORMATIONS: A short, succinct statement that conveys a single idea about processes that make raw data usable, such as filtering, validating, parsing, formatting, and cleaning.

Lens - Experience

As a: <perspective>

I want to know

_____

_____

EXPERIENCE: A short, succinct statement that conveys a single idea about the use of the dataset in experimental, production, or research practice.

Lens - n=1

As a: <perspective>

I want to know

_____

_____

n = 1: A short, succinct statement that conveys a single idea about actual samples of data - in distribution, out-of-distribution, etc.

Activity — Lens Brainstorm

Lens - Origins

As a: ML data scientist

I want to know
If the publishers thought about fairness when deciding to make the dataset.

ORIGINS: A short, succinct statement that conveys a single idea about the early stages of a dataset's lifecycle when decisions to create a dataset are made.

Lens - Factuals

As a: ML data scientist

I want to know
If the dataset is large enough for my specific task.

FACTUALS: A short, succinct statement that conveys a single idea about the process of collecting, labeling, rating examples, and corresponding outputs.

Lens - Transformations

As a: ML data scientist

I want to know
If and how the data was aggregated.

TRANSFORMATIONS: A short, succinct statement that conveys a single idea about processes that make raw data usable, such as filtering, validating, parsing, formatting, and cleaning.

Lens - Experience

As a: ML data scientist

I want to know
If the dataset can be used for ensemble learning tasks.

EXPERIENCE: A short, succinct statement that conveys a single idea about the use of the dataset in experimental, production, or research practice.

Lens - n=1

As a: ML data scientist

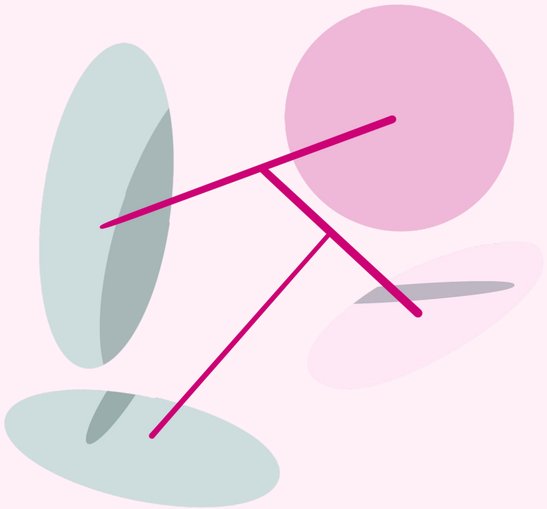
I want to know
What types of examples are uncharacteristic of this dataset.

n = 1: A short, succinct statement that conveys a single idea about actual samples of data - in distribution, out-of-distribution, etc.

Lens Brainstorm

Create and prioritize Agent Information Journeys for your Data Card that can be tracked over time.

- Create perspective-lens pairs that capture your top agents' information needs
- Brainstorm lenses that are succinct and convey a single idea
- Use OFTEn prompts in Lens Cards to establish well-balanced foundations for your Data Card template



Brainstorm and prioritize lenses for your agents

Step 1: Review your agents

Step 2: Individually, fill out as many Lens Cards as possible for your agents

Step 3: Prioritize your lens cards and share with the group

Step 4: Cluster and vote on your most important lenses

Step 5: Transfer results to the Lens Brainstorm tab in your tracker

These will form the backbone of your Data Card.
Subsequent activities will expand these AIJs to include in your Data Card.

Activity — Lens Brainstorm

As a(n) [agent], I want to know [**origins**]	As a(n) [agent], I want to know [**factuals**]	As a(n) [agent], I want to know [**transformations**]	As a(n) [agent], I want to know [**experience**]	As a(n) [agent], I want to know [**n=1**]

Fill out as many Lens Cards as possible. Go over all OFTEn stages, pushing past the obvious ideas.

A lens is a short succinct statement which conveys a single idea about:

ORIGINS: the early stages of a dataset's lifecycle when decisions to create a dataset are made.

FACTUALS: the process of collecting, labeling, rating examples, and corresponding outputs.

TRANSFORMATIONS: Processes that make raw data usable, such as filtering, validating, parsing, formatting, and cleaning.

EXPERIENCE: The use of the dataset in experimental, production, or research practice

n = 1: Actual samples of data - in distribution, out-of-distribution, etc.

Pro-tips for Lens Brainstorm

📌 **Pick one**
Pick one OFTEn category, even if they overlap; that's ok

🎭 **Keep it grounded**
Think about agents as groups of people; your lenses are about real people

🙆🏽‍♀️ **Strive for high level**
A sign of a good lens = can it be converted into a title?

🥇 **One is wonderful**
Each lens should communicate a single idea

👌 **Always be refining**
Perfect, consolidate, and revise your lenses based on clusters and context

Next steps

OUTCOMES

–

Define and decide on the most important information journeys of your Data Card or documentation.

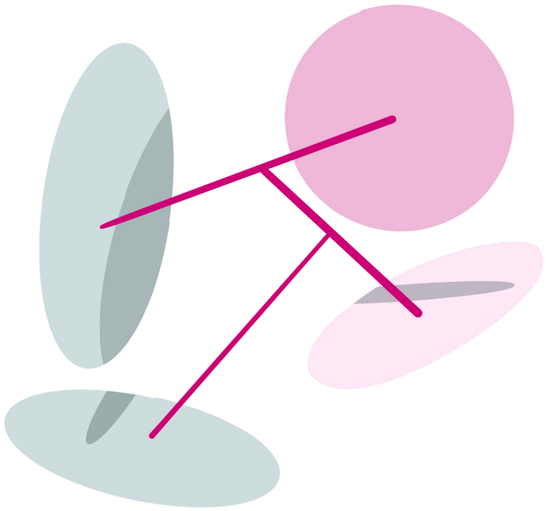
FOLLOW UP

–

→ Update your Activity Tracker

→ Next: Scopes Brainstorm

→ Later: Templatize



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